Vatsal Thakkar

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Residency Status – Australian Citizen

PROFFESIONAL SUMMARY

I am a highly driven individual with a deep passion for STEM and continuous learning. With several years of experience in small teams to deliver innovative solutions and exceptional results, I have proficiency in a range of software tools, particularly Autodesk Inventor, and am always eager to learn new programs to enhance my creative capabilities. As a committed team player, I take full responsibility for my role and give 100% effort and dedication. I also always strive to deliver excellent results. Currently pursuing my Honours in Mechanical Engineering with Banking and Finance, I am focused on refining my skills in management, communication, technology, and leadership.

EDUCATION

Jan 2024 – Present **University of Adelaide**
B. Engineering (Honours)(Mechanical) with B. Finance and Banking
GPA: 6.9/7 – Expected to graduate in 2028

- Participated in the Engineers Without Borders Challenge (2024)
- Member of the Adelaide University Space Society
- Member of Adelaide Mechanical Engineering Student Society

Jan 2019 – Dec 2023 **The Heights School (R-12)**

- Dux in Mathematical Methods, Physics, Digital Communications (CAD)
- School Dux with ATAR of 98.05
- Merit in Digital Communications (CAD)
- Participated in various STEM projects and competitions
- Volunteered to aid educators in classes as a support and a mentor

WORK EXPERIENCE

Dec 2023 – Present **Senior Salesperson – Harvey Norman Holdings Limited**
Gepps Cross, Adelaide

- Part of the sales team specializing in computing and mobile products, providing expert guidance and customer support.
- Developed strong communication skills, ensuring customer satisfaction, effective sales techniques, and strategic merchandising.
- Trained in handling sensitive customer information, operating POS systems, and making sales decisions for the company in a fast-paced environment.
- Trained in organising important paperwork, filing proper documents, gathering appropriate information from customers, and signing contracts.
- Consistently met individual and team KPIs while representing the company with professionalism and enthusiasm.
- Trained to create invoices, handle cash, and operate transitions between customer and company.

Jan 2022 – Present **Customer & Operations Supervisor – JT Car Rentals Pty Ltd**
Hillcrest, Adelaide & Para Hills West, Adelaide

- Responsible for customer service and operations to book cars in and out.
- Managing the fleet to ensure cleanliness and that the car are ready to be booked.
- Operated POS systems and strong communication with team members.
- Created invoices, handled payments between customer and company, and handled appropriate filing and documentation for all transactions.
- Aided in financial planning, analysis, and decision making.

Aug 2020 – Dec 2023 **Crew Trainer – McDonalds Australia**
Golden Grove, Adelaide

- Oversaw kitchen operations, ensuring all tasks were completed efficiently, maintaining high-quality standards and timely service.
- Demonstrated strong leadership and team management, coordinating with managers to optimize workflow and maintain smooth operations.
- Delegated responsibilities strategically to maximize efficiency, speed, and overall team performance.
- Maintained clear and effective communication with staff, fostering teamwork and a collaborative environment.
- Provided exceptional customer service, ensuring a positive dining experience and resolving concerns professionally.
- Trained in cash handling, transaction processing, and POS system operations, managing financial exchanges with accuracy and responsibility.

PROJECTS

Jan 2020 – Mar 2024 **SUBS IN SCHOOL TECHNOLOGY CHALLENGE**
Team Leader & Engineering Lead

- Organised by Re-Engineering Australia, this challenge involved teams which designed and constructed small submarines which operate on a battery in the water. The teams are required to design and manufacture the submarine independently while:
  - Gathering sponsorships and being involved with stakeholders
  - Creating portfolios to outline engineering and marketing strategies and processes
  - Managing budgets, raising funds, and managing risks
  - Using effective communication between teams
- I participated in two state competitions (2021 and 2023) and one national competition (2022), placing 3rd in Australia at nationals, and 3rd and 1st in the state competition respectively.
- I created professional industry level technical drawings, CAD models, and contributed many hours voluntarily to achieve the best results.

2019 & 2023 **The Oliphant Science Awards**
Participants (2019) & 2nd Place winners (2023)

- Designed and manufactured interactive displays to demonstrate various physical phenomena, particularly Faradays and Lenz's Law of electromagnetism.

2021 to 2023 **Tutor and Mentor**
The Heights School (R-12)

- Aided educators in running classes, preparing class materials, planning lessons, and marking student work.
- Helped mentor classes and individuals involved in SUBS IN SCHOOL and various other STEM competitions using experience from my involvement in past competitions and knowledge in engineering, mathematics, and science.

SKILLS

- Autodesk Inventor (proficient, experienced)
- MATLAB (proficient)
- Microsoft Office Suite (proficient)
- Adobe Illustrator (proficient)
- VS Code (intermediate)
- Various POS Systems
- Fast Learner
- Team Leadership
- Communication
- Customer Satisfaction
- Time management
- Multitasking
- Collaboration
- Excellent work ethic
- Responsible

QUALIFICATIONS

Licences

- Drivers License (P2 ends December 2025)

Tertiary Qualifications

- Certificate II in Retail Services, completed 2023

INTERESTS

Computers New technologies, PCs, new mobiles, and computer hardware. Interests in creating homemade servers, recycling old PCs into usable machines, and experimenting with various operating systems.

REFEREES

Amber Ashton | Restaurant Manager - Golden Grove McDonalds
Amber.ashton@au.stores.mcd.com

Lachlan Canale | Operations Manager Harvey Norman Gepps Cross
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